

SEO Quick Checklist

2026 Edition

30 actionable points to rank higher in Google, AI Overviews, and answer engines.

Coverage

Technical SEO

On-Page SEO

Content & Authority

AI Search (AEO/GEO)

Off-Page

Technical SEO

- Site indexed in Google Search Console
- XML sitemap submitted and error-free
- Core Web Vitals pass (LCP < 2.5s, FID < 100ms, CLS < 0.1)
- Mobile-friendly test passes on all pages
- HTTPS enforced with valid SSL certificate
- No broken links or 404 errors
- Canonical tags set correctly everywhere
- robots.txt not blocking critical pages
- Schema markup present (Article, FAQ, Breadcrumb)

On-Page SEO

- Title tag under 60 chars with primary keyword
- Meta description under 160 chars with CTA
- H1 matches page topic with primary keyword
- Content uses clear H2/H3 hierarchy
- Images have descriptive alt text
- Internal links to related content
- URLs are short, descriptive, keyword-rich
- Open Graph & Twitter Card meta tags set

Content & Authority

- Content is original and in-depth (1,000+ words)
- Targets search intent (informational / navigational / transactional)
- EEAT signals: author bio, citations, credentials
- Outbound links to authoritative sources
- Content refreshed within last 6 months
- Featured snippet format used (lists, tables, Q&A)

AI Search Optimization (AEO / GEO)

- Structured data markup (FAQ, HowTo, Article)
- Content answers direct questions concisely
- Entity clarity: named entities defined explicitly
- Citable content: stats sourced, claims backed

loop paper LLM-friendly tables, lists, bold key phrases

Off-Page & Local

- 10+ unique referring domains in backlink profile
- Anchor text diversity (branded, generic, partial)
- Brand mentions across relevant industry sites
- Google Business Profile claimed (if local)
- NAP consistent across all directories